

CANADA

Canada – Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Canada
Short Form	Canada
Capital	Ottawa
Region (UN)	Western European and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Federal parliamentary democracy and constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Charles III, represented by Governor General Mary Simon
Head of Government	Prime Minister Justin Trudeau
Currency	Canadian Dollar (CAD)
UN Member Since	9 November 1945 (Founding Member)
MUN Standing	Active contributor to peacekeeping, human rights advocacy, and multilateral diplomacy; known for promoting gender equality and Indigenous rights within UN frameworks.

Recommended Books on Canada's Foreign Policy & UN Role

Title	Author(s)	Why It's Relevant
<i>Canada and the United Nations: Legacies, Limits, Prospects</i>	Colin McCullough & Robert Teigrob	Explores Canada's historical and contemporary roles within the UN system.
<i>Pearson's Peacekeepers: Canada and the United Nations Emergency Force, 1956–67</i>	Michael K. Carroll	Analyzes Canada's pivotal role in the development of UN peacekeeping missions.
<i>Canada's Voice: The Public Life of John G. Diefenbaker</i>	Denis Smith	Provides insight into Canada's foreign policy decisions during the Cold War era.
<i>The International Politics of Human Rights: Rallying to the R2P Cause?</i>	Monica Serrano & Thomas G. Weiss	Discusses Canada's involvement in the Responsibility to Protect doctrine.
<i>Gendering Peace: UN Peacebuilding in Timor-Leste</i>	Katrina Lee-Koo	Examines Canada's contributions to gender-focused peacebuilding efforts.

Research Table: Canada & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UNHRC – Canada Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/canada	Repository of reviews, letters, and country-specific concerns.
UPR Reports – Canada	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ca-index	Access to Canada's periodic reviews and recommendations.
UN Web TV – Canada in HRC	https://webtv.un.org	Find video recordings of

Sessions		Canada's statements in HRC.
Amnesty International Canada – HRC Reports	https://www.amnesty.ca	Shadow reports and critiques relevant to Canada's human rights record.
Human Rights Watch – Canada	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/canada	Independent evaluation of civil rights and justice issues.
Truth and Reconciliation Commission Reports	https://nctr.ca/records/reports/	Key documents referenced in Indigenous rights discussions at the UN.
UN Treaty Body Database – Canada	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/TBSearch.aspx?Lang=en&TreatyID=1&CountryID=31	Human rights instruments signed by Canada.
Canadian Human Rights Commission	https://www.chrc-ccdp.gc.ca	Provides official reports and frameworks submitted to UNHRC.
Inter-American Commission on Human Rights – Canada	https://www.oas.org/en/iachr/	Regional mechanisms overlapping with UN mandates.
Canadian Civil Liberties Association	https://ccla.org	Offers reports used in NGO submissions to UNHRC.
Global Justice Journal – Canada & Human Rights	https://globaljustice.queenslaw.ca	Reviews Canadian compliance with international law.
Université de Montréal Human Rights Observatory	https://droit.umontreal.ca/recherche/unites-de-recherche/observatoire-des-droits-humains/	Supports policy papers for HRC hearings.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Canada Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/canada (socialrightscura.ca , freedomhouse.org , ohchr.org)	Official summary of Canada's treaty status and OHCHR work—a UNHRC baseline.
OHCHR – Country Visits by Special Rapporteurs	https://spinternet.ohchr.org/ViewCountryVisits.aspx?Lang=en&country=CAN&visitType=all	Lists expert missions on genocide, Indigenous, housing,

		detention— showing scrutiny over diverse rights issues.
OHCHR Press Release – Water & Sanitation	https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2024/04/canada-must-strengthen-efforts-guarantee-right-water-and-sanitation	Highlights land and water rights of Indigenous communities— key HRC thematic focus.
HRW UPR Submission (Apr 2023)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2023/04/05/submission-universal-periodic-review-canada	NGO analysis of Canada's UPR progress, including missing reforms.
Amnesty UPR Submission (Nov 2023 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/documents/amr20/6627/2023/en/	Focuses on refugee, migrant, Indigenous, and policing issues ahead of UPR.
Amnesty – Oral Statement Item 6 (HRC55)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/documents/ior40/7838/2024/en/	Civil-society submission during Council debate on UPR follow-up.
OHCHR – Special Rapporteur on Slavery (Canada visit)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/documents/country-reports/ahrc5746add1-visit-canada-report-special-rapporteur-contemporary-forms	Investigates forced labor among migrant workers— including temporary worker abuse.
State Dept – Canada 2023 HR Report (PDF)	https://www.state.gov/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/528267_CANADA-2023-HUMAN-RIGHTS-REPORT.pdf	US government overview: discrimination, detention, migrant treatment.
State Dept – Canada 2022 HR Report (PDF)	https://www.state.gov/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/415610_CANADA-2022-HUMAN-RIGHTS-REPORT.pdf	Detailed rounds on Indigenous, judicial, detention issues.
OHCHR – Special Visit: Indigenous Rights (2023)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/media-advisories/2023/02/un-expert-indigenous-peoples-rights-visit-canada	Mandate visit invited by Canada—about

		housing, culture, justice.
Amnesty 2018 UPR Submission (PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/AMR2073622017ENGLISH.pdf	Critique on insufficient UPR reform uptake and data gaps.
Amnesty 2021 Bill C-27 Brief (PDF)	https://www.ourcommons.ca/Content/Committee/441/INDU/Brief/BR12951650/br-external/Jointly12-067-240301-015-e.pdf	Submission on proposed AI and privacy law during HRC digital rights discourse.
Canadian Justice – UNDRIP Act (2021)	https://www.justice.gc.ca/eng/declaration/about-apropos.html	National implementation of Indigenous rights per UN standard—relevant to HRC dialogue.
Canadian Justice – Implementation Advisory (Mar 2025)	https://www.canada.ca/en/department-justice/news/2025/03/government-of-canada-establishes-indigenous-led-advisory-committee-to-advance-un-declaration-act-implementation.html	Highlights creation of Indigenous-led advisory committee—landmark UNDRIP progress.
Amnesty Canada – 2023 UPR Digital/Environment Submission (PDF)	https://amnesty.ca/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/aices-2023-hra-web.pdf	Addresses environmental and digital rights—ties to HRC tech and environment themes.
OHCHR – Arbitrary Detention Experts Visit (2024)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/media-advisories/2024/05/un-experts-arbitrary-detention-visit-canada	Examination of migrant detention conditions—a core HRC accountability issue.
Amnesty 2013 UPR Critique (PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=11374	Historic reflection on slow progress, especially in migrant and Indigenous rights.
Freedom House – Canada Profile	https://freedomhouse.org/country/canada/freedom-world/2023	Independent civil/political

2023		rights score—contextual benchmark for UNHRC.
HRW – Canada Country Page	https://www.hrw.org/americas/canada	Ongoing reports: Indigenous, migrant, remote community, policing issues.
Amnesty – 2018 UPR Missed Opportunities	https://www.amnesty.org/en/documents/amr20/9142/2018/en/	NGO reflections on ineffective UPR follow-up—adds credibility expectations.

Unique Aspects: Canada's UNHRC Profile

1. **Indigenous Rights & Water Justice:** Special Rapporteurs are coming to tackle important issues like boil-water advisories, housing, and land equity—key topics in the UNHRC discussions on human rights.
2. **Migrant & Temporary Worker Protections:** Expert reports have uncovered serious issues like debt bondage and labor abuse, which have now put Canada on the Human Rights Council's agenda regarding business and forced labor.
3. **Dual Digital & Environmental Rights Focus:** The submissions regarding AI, data privacy, and climate change showcase Canada's increasing involvement in contemporary rights issues along the thematic lines of the UN Human Rights Council.
4. **Arbitrary Detention Reform Pressure:** The OHCHR's visit highlights the need for improvements in detention protocols, which raises the stakes for accountability within the Council.
5. **UNDRIP Implementation Model:** Legislation backed by Indigenous expert groups showcases Canada as a prime example of how to weave UN standards into its own laws.
6. **UPR Follow-Up Deficits Highlighted:** Several reviews from Amnesty and Human Rights Watch highlight a lack of action on recommendations, turning compliance into a transparency concern for the UN Human Rights Council.
7. **Freedom House Affirmation vs. Domestic Flaws:** The high ratings alongside the persistent issues faced by Indigenous and migrant communities highlight a complexity that the Council acknowledges.
8. **Civil Society Voice in HRC Debates:** Amnesty's spoken contributions during Council sessions highlight the vital role that NGOs play in influencing policy.
9. **OHCHR Expert Missions as Watchdogs:** Visiting Special Rapporteurs, like those focusing on issues such as slavery and detention, point out that Canada has a notably deep involvement with UN mandates.
10. **Balanced Rights Record Under Review:** Canada is often seen as a leading democracy, yet it frequently encounters criticism, which makes its situation a complex topic in discussions about human rights at the UN.